

DEPARTMENT OF COMPUTER SCIENCE & ENGINEERING - CYBER SECURITY

Hack Fest – Capture The Flag (CTF) Event Report

The Department of Computer Science and Engineering - Cyber Security, ATME College of Engineering, successfully organized a one-day workshop followed by an event on “**Hack Fest – Capture the Flag (CTF)**” on 22nd April 2026 in AB 201, ATMECE Campus. The workshop was conducted with the primary objective of introducing students to cybersecurity concepts, ethical hacking techniques, and real-world problem-solving through a competitive platform. The resource person for the workshop was Members of Cybrtron club, CSE-CY, ATMECE, Mysuru, who brought valuable industry insights and practical expertise to the sessions. The event was coordinated by Mrs. Suhsini, Assistant Professor, and convened under the guidance of Dr. Nasreen Fathima, Head of the Department, CSE-CY. A total of 11 teams, each consisting 3 members (33 students) from 1st and 2nd year students of the branch CSE-CY actively participated in the workshop.

The workshop was meticulously structured to focus on introducing students to the fundamentals of Capture the Flag (CTF) competitions and cybersecurity problem-solving techniques. Participants were guided through different categories of CTF challenges, including:

- Cryptography
- Digital Forensics
- Basic Networking

Students were taught how to approach CTF problems systematically, including techniques for decoding encrypted messages, identifying vulnerabilities in web applications, analysing files, and using logical reasoning to extract hidden flags. The session also introduced commonly used tools and platforms in cybersecurity, helping students understand practical workflows.

The workshop sessions were effectively conducted by the members of the Cybetrion Club, who enriched the learning experience by sharing practical knowledge, real-time problem-solving approaches, and insights into current trends in cybersecurity and ethical hacking. Their hands-on guidance and peer-driven teaching approach helped students gain a deeper understanding of CTF concepts beyond theoretical learning. The interactive nature of the

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sessions encouraged active participation, critical thinking, and problem-solving skills among the students.

Following the workshop conducted on 22nd April 2026, the **Hack Fest – Capture The Flag (CTF) Competition** was successfully held on **24th April 2026** from **10:00 AM to 5:00 PM** at ATMECE Campus. The competition was organized to provide participants with a platform to apply the concepts learned during the workshop in a real-time, competitive cybersecurity environment.

The event commenced with a brief introduction to the rules and guidelines of the competition. Participants were then given access to the CTF platform, where a series of challenges were hosted across multiple domains such as cryptography, web exploitation, reverse engineering, digital forensics, and networking. The challenges were designed with varying levels of difficulty to test participants' analytical thinking, technical skills, and problem-solving abilities.

The competition was conducted using the CTFd platform, which provided a dynamic and user-friendly interface for hosting challenges and tracking progress. Each team was required to solve challenges and submit the corresponding “flags” through the platform. Points were awarded based on the complexity of the challenges, and a **live scoreboard** was maintained throughout the event, ensuring transparency in evaluation and creating a competitive atmosphere.

Participants actively engaged in solving challenges throughout the day, demonstrating strong teamwork, persistence, and innovative thinking. The event witnessed high enthusiasm and continuous participation, with teams competing to secure top positions on the leaderboard.

At the conclusion of the competition, the winners were determined based on the final scores displayed on the scoreboard. The top **two teams** with the highest points were declared as winners and were recognized for their outstanding performance, technical expertise, and problem-solving capabilities.

The **evaluation process** was entirely automated through the CTF platform, ensuring fairness, accuracy, and real-time ranking of participants. The event concluded with the announcement of winners, followed by appreciation for all participants and organizers for their active involvement. As a token of appreciation and to encourage competitive learning, cash prizes were awarded to the top-performing teams based on their final rankings on the CTF platform.

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The winners of the Hack Fest – CTF Competition were determined based on their final scores on the live scoreboard hosted on the CTFd platform. The evaluation was fully automated and reflected real-time performance of all participating teams.

According to the final results (*as shown in the scoreboard*):

First Place

Team: *Flag_Hunters*

Year: 2nd Year

Prize: ₹1000 Cash Prize

Team Members:

- 4AD24CY036 – Prathik Sing N
- 4AD24CY023 – Manjunath R
- 4AD24CY003 – B Abhishek

Second Place

Team: *DED GANG*

Year: 1st Year

Prize: ₹500 Cash Prize

Team Members:

- 4AD25CY018 – Mohamed Rihab Ulhaq
- 4AD25CY020 – Mohammed Zahid Irfan
- 4AD25CY040 – Suha Mirza

The Department expresses its sincere gratitude to the members of the **Cybetron Club** and all the participants for their enthusiastic involvement and support in making the workshop and Hack Fest a grand success. The event concluded on a positive note, with students expressing valuable feedback and appreciating the hands-on learning experience gained through this event. Many participants also suggested organizing more such workshops and competitions in the future to further enhance their practical knowledge and exposure to real-world cybersecurity practices, reflecting the overall effectiveness and impact of the program.

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Photo Gallery:



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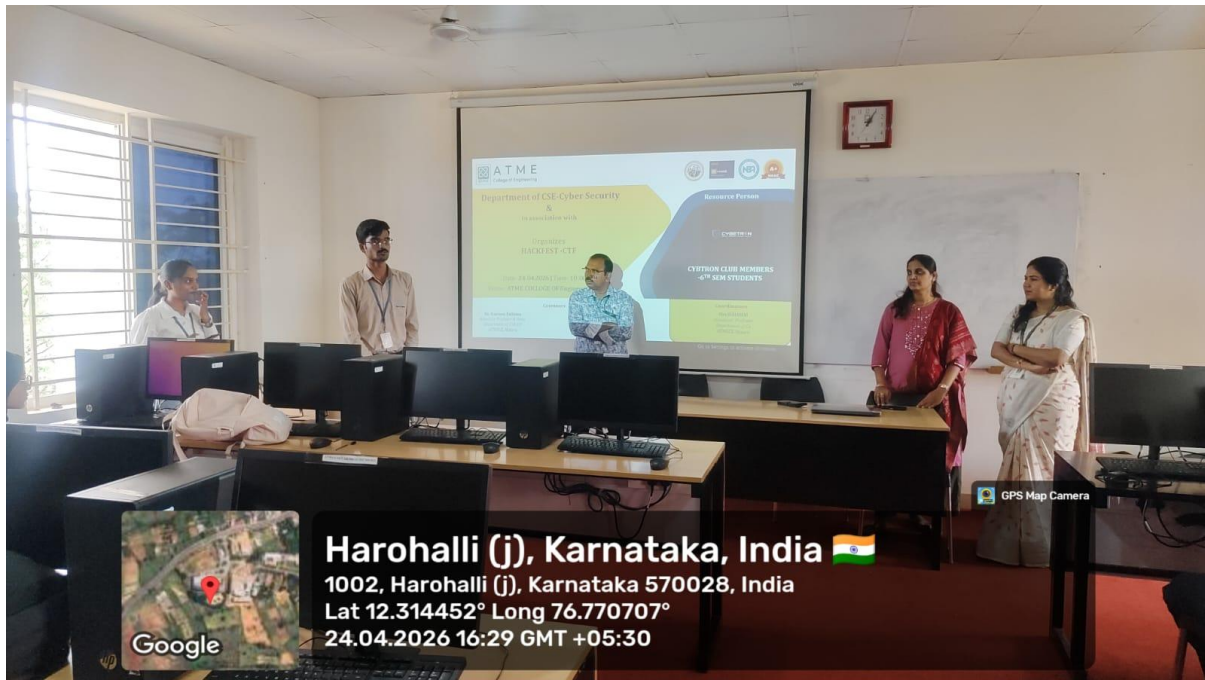
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